

James Tannahill

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Investor and operator with 10+ years across PE-backed, public, and growth-stage companies; \$400M+ deployed across 30+ investments. Combines fundamental modeling depth (LBO, DCF, M&A, accretion/dilution) with hands-on engineering: designs and ships production Python/AWS ML and LLM systems end to end.

Since 2018, one continuous thread: built the NLP pipelines that turn unstructured text into signal (Accrete), delivered that signal to \$5B+ institutional funds (M Science / Jefferies), now train frontier models to produce it (xAI).

CORE COMPETENCIES

Fundamental & Event-Driven Research | Healthcare & Life Sciences | Alternative Data | Financial Modeling (LBO, DCF, M&A) | Due Diligence & Valuation | AI/ML Infrastructure & Applied LLMs | Python, SQL, AWS | P&L Ownership | Capital Raises

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

xAI (SpaceX) - AI/ML for Capital Markets

New York, NY | 2025 - Present

Training data and evaluation systems for frontier models reasoning over institutional capital markets.

- Own the financial-reasoning data and evaluation stack used to train and grade frontier models across the full lifecycle (pre-training, mid-training, supervised fine-tuning, RLHF/RLVR, and post-training alignment) on institutional capital-markets reasoning.
- Author binary-weighted grading rubrics and difficulty-gated adversarial tasks spanning LBO, DCF, credit, and M&A / accretion-dilution that isolate specific reasoning failure modes and discriminate between frontier models where standard benchmarks saturate.
- Engineer the production Python/AWS tooling behind the eval pipeline: verifiable reward signals (RLVR), automated graders, and large-scale curation of raw financial text into training and evaluation datasets.

Plocamium Holdings (Family Investment Office) - Principal, then President

New York, NY | 2015 - 2025

Third-generation family investment office across healthcare, industrials, and manufacturing; scaled from principal to president. Held concurrently with the roles below. Parent entity of 1Ness Strategies and RDLB.

- Rose from principal to president of a platform that deployed \$400M+ across 30+ investments in healthcare services, life sciences, industrial technology, and manufacturing; personally originated, underwrote, and led 11 of those deals end to end, from sourcing through exit.
- Led a \$22M growth-equity investment in a surgical-implant manufacturer (35% revenue growth) and a \$25M investment in a healthcare-analytics platform; sourced and structured a \$3M co-investment in digital diagnostics.

1Ness Strategies (Plocamium operating company) - Co-Founder & CEO

New York, NY | 2023 - 2025

- Built healthcare services company from zero to 80+ clients and \$1.5M+ monthly managed revenue; profitable within 18 months on disciplined unit economics.

RDLB (Plocamium affiliate) - Board Partner

New York, NY | 2024 - 2026

- Advise on \$150M+ in capital raises; investor communications frameworks reduced diligence cycles 25-30%. Governance restructuring contributed to 15-20% EV uplift.

Vaxart, Inc. (NASDAQ: VXRT) - AVP, Strategic Finance

New York, NY | 2021 - 2023

- Led \$100M+ in strategic transactions: \$50M manufacturing facility acquisition and \$50M+ in BARDA/DoD non-dilutive grants; built NPV/DCF models tied to clinical milestones.

M Science (Jefferies Group) - Senior Associate

New York, NY | 2019 - 2020

- Delivered alternative-data healthcare research to institutional investors including hedge funds running \$5B+ AUM, combining panel signal with fundamental modeling to surface tradable conclusions ahead of consensus.

Accrete.AI - Associate

New York, NY | 2018 - 2019

- Designed the data architecture and built ingestion pipelines that curated Twitter/X API, news, and clinical text into training datasets for dual-use (defense/healthcare) models.

H.C. Wainwright & Co. - Equity Research Analyst, Biotechnology

New York, NY | 2016 - 2018

- Initiated coverage on 50+ biotech names; authored institutional research and built DCF and comparable-company valuation models. FINRA Series 7, 63, 86/87.

SELECTED SYSTEMS BUILT

- Multi-agent research and entity-intelligence engine** - 26 AWS Lambdas across two Step Functions pipelines ingesting 141 live sources into a 400-entity knowledge graph (12.8K edges)
- Systematic trading agents** - live order execution against Alpaca and Kalshi, deployed on ECS Fargate
- Signal validation harness** - walk-forward and sealed out-of-sample splits scored on Deflated and Probabilistic Sharpe Ratios, built to separate genuine edge from overfitting before capital is committed

EDUCATION

Cornell University, SC Johnson College of Business - MBA | University of Essex - MSc Biotechnology | Denison University - BS Biochemistry